

STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE

Shift Handover & Incident Escalation

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1. Purpose

This procedure defines a consistent, auditable process for handing over a shift and escalating incidents. It ensures no information is lost between shifts, incidents reach the right person quickly, and every action is documented for review and compliance.

2. Scope

Applies to all operations and security personnel across all shifts (day, night, weekend) at the site. Covers routine shift handover, incident logging, and escalation up to management. Excludes HR and payroll processes.

3. Definitions

Term	Meaning	Example
Incident	Any unplanned event requiring a response or record	Alarm activation, equipment fault
Handover	Structured transfer of duties and information between shifts	End-of-shift briefing + log review
Escalation	Raising an incident to a higher authority per severity	Notifying the Duty Manager of a breach

4. Roles & Responsibilities

- 4.1** Outgoing Operator — completes all log entries, briefs the incoming operator, and confirms open items are handed over.
- 4.2** Incoming Operator — reviews the log, confirms understanding of open items, and signs the handover record.
- 4.3** Shift Supervisor — verifies the handover is complete and resolves any gaps before releasing the outgoing shift.
- 4.4** Duty Manager — receives escalations at Severity 2 and above and authorises further action.

5. Procedure — Shift Handover

- 5.1** Fifteen minutes before shift end, the outgoing operator finalises all log entries for the shift.
- 5.2** Outgoing and incoming operators review the log together, focusing on open/unresolved items.
- 5.3** Outgoing operator briefs on: site status, equipment issues, access exceptions, and any incident in progress.
- 5.4** Both operators sign the handover record (date, time, names). The supervisor countersigns.
- 5.5** Any item that cannot be closed is flagged as 'open' with an owner and expected resolution time.

6. Procedure — Incident Escalation

Assess severity, then escalate per the matrix below. Log the incident first, then notify — never delay logging.

Severity	Escalate to	Timeframe
S1 — Minor (no impact)	Log only; note at handover	Same shift
S2 — Moderate (localised impact)	Shift Supervisor	Within 30 minutes
S3 — Major (site impact / safety)	Duty Manager + Supervisor	Immediately (≤10 min)
S4 — Critical (emergency)	Emergency services + Duty Manager	Immediately, then log

7. Records & Compliance

All handover records and incident logs are retained for a minimum of 12 months and are subject to periodic audit. Entries must be accurate, timestamped, and attributable. Falsifying or omitting records is a disciplinary matter.

8. Revision History

Version	Date	Change
1.0	2026	Initial issue